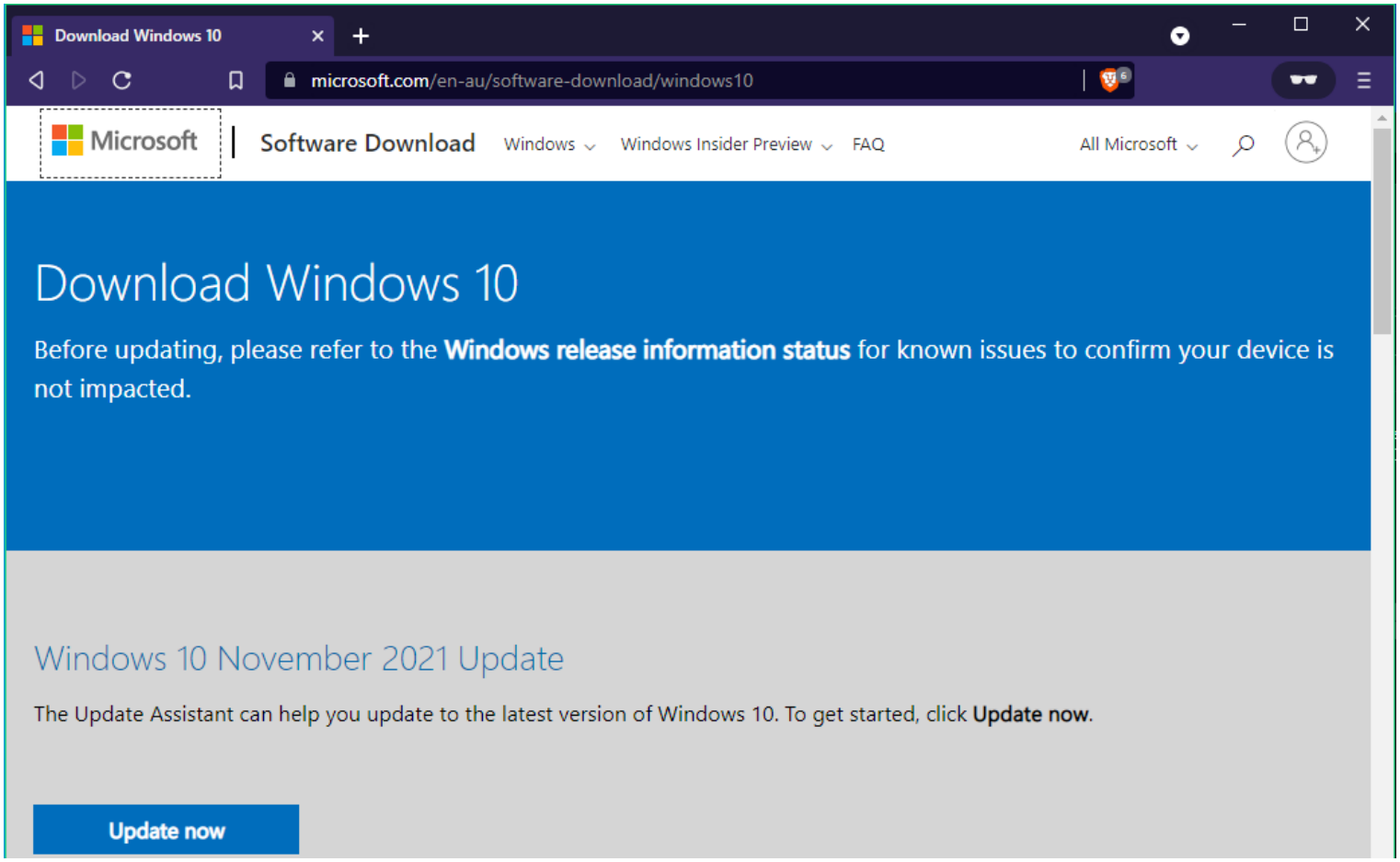
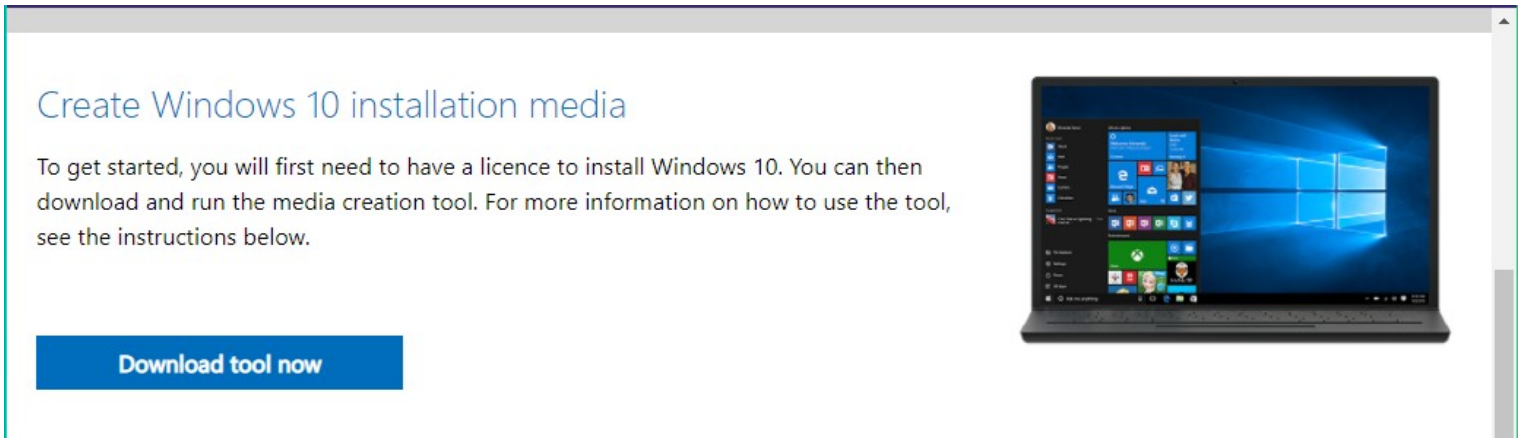
Windows 10 Download - 20/01/2022

1. Head to your favourite search engine and search for “Windows 10 ISO” and look for microsoft.com link or simply click this link to take you straight there:
https://www.microsoft.com/en-au/software-download/windows10 (opens in new tab)



2. Looking at the page, it does not immediately provide a direct link to download Windows 10. Instead it offers a link to download the Media Creation Tool which effectively creates an .iso image of your current Windows 10 OS.



3. Open Developer-tools in your web browser

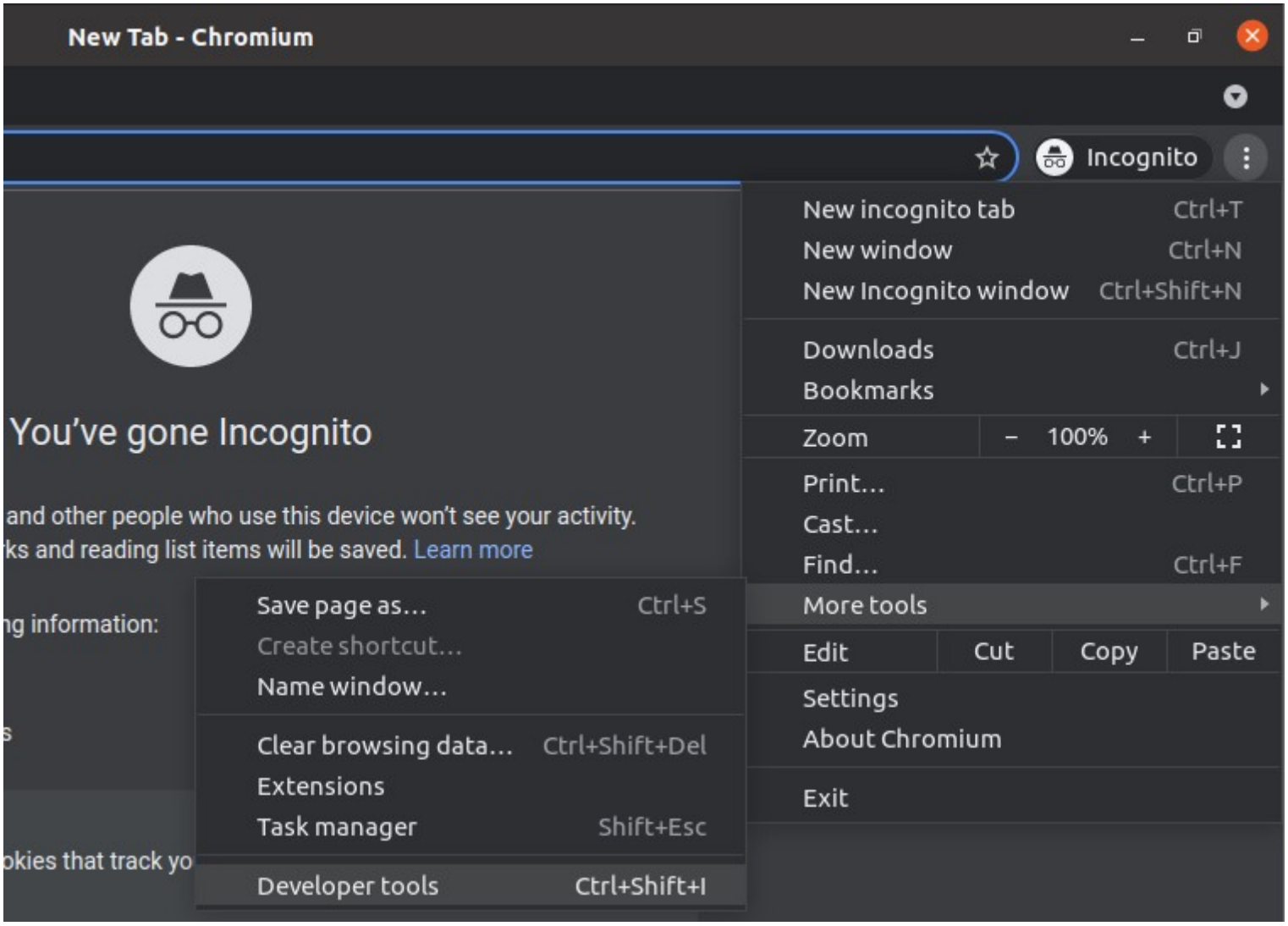
By using the built-in developer tools feature of your web-browser we can manipulate the device fingerprint therefore making the Download server think we are not using a compatible Windows device for the Media Creation tool. The end result is a download link to a fresh Windows 10 ISO file.

To open developer tools simply use either of these 2 methods;

Keyboard shortcut for Chromium-based (Brave, Chrome) and Firefox Browsers is “ control + shift + i ”

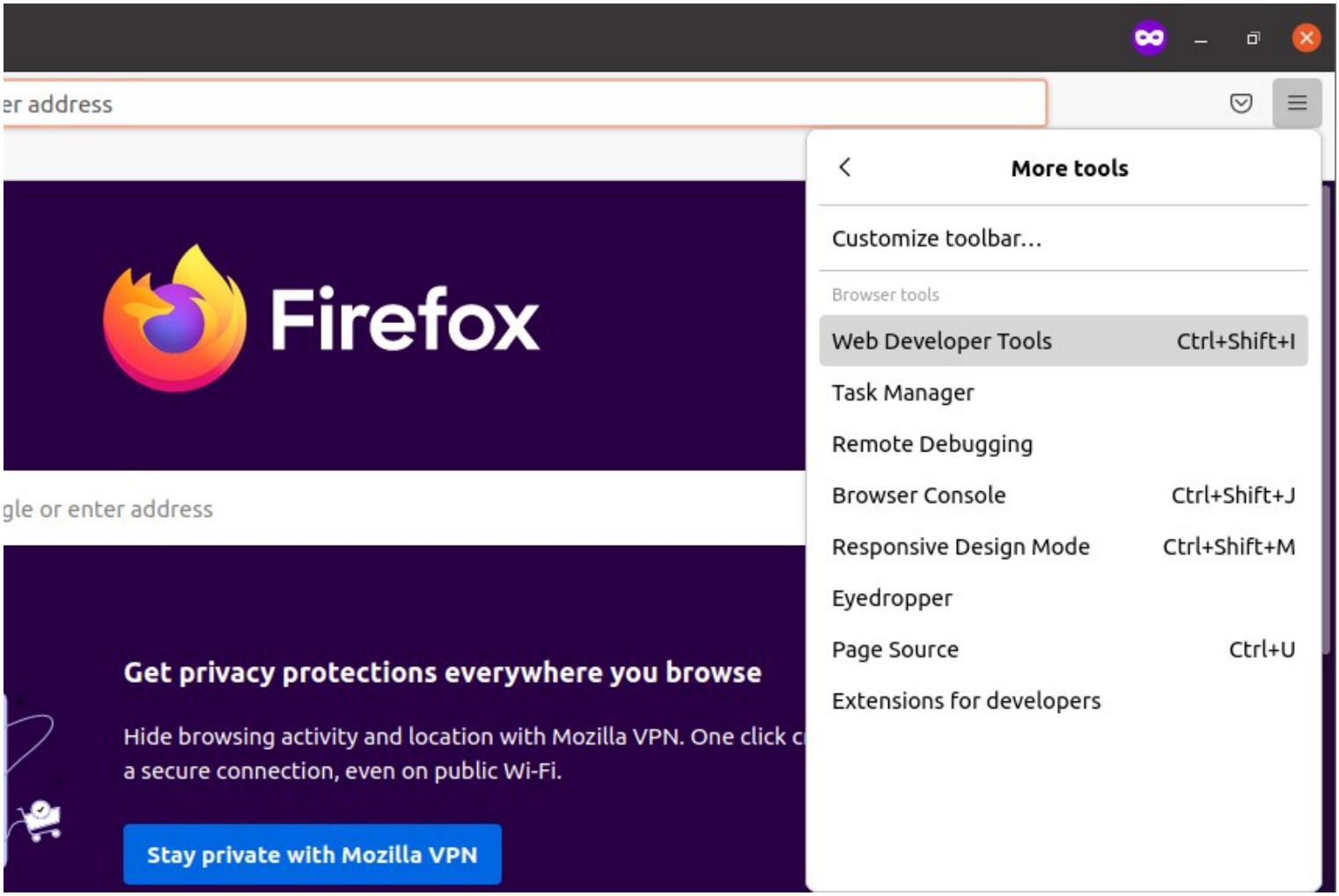
Or Via the web-browsers menu:

Chromium-Based



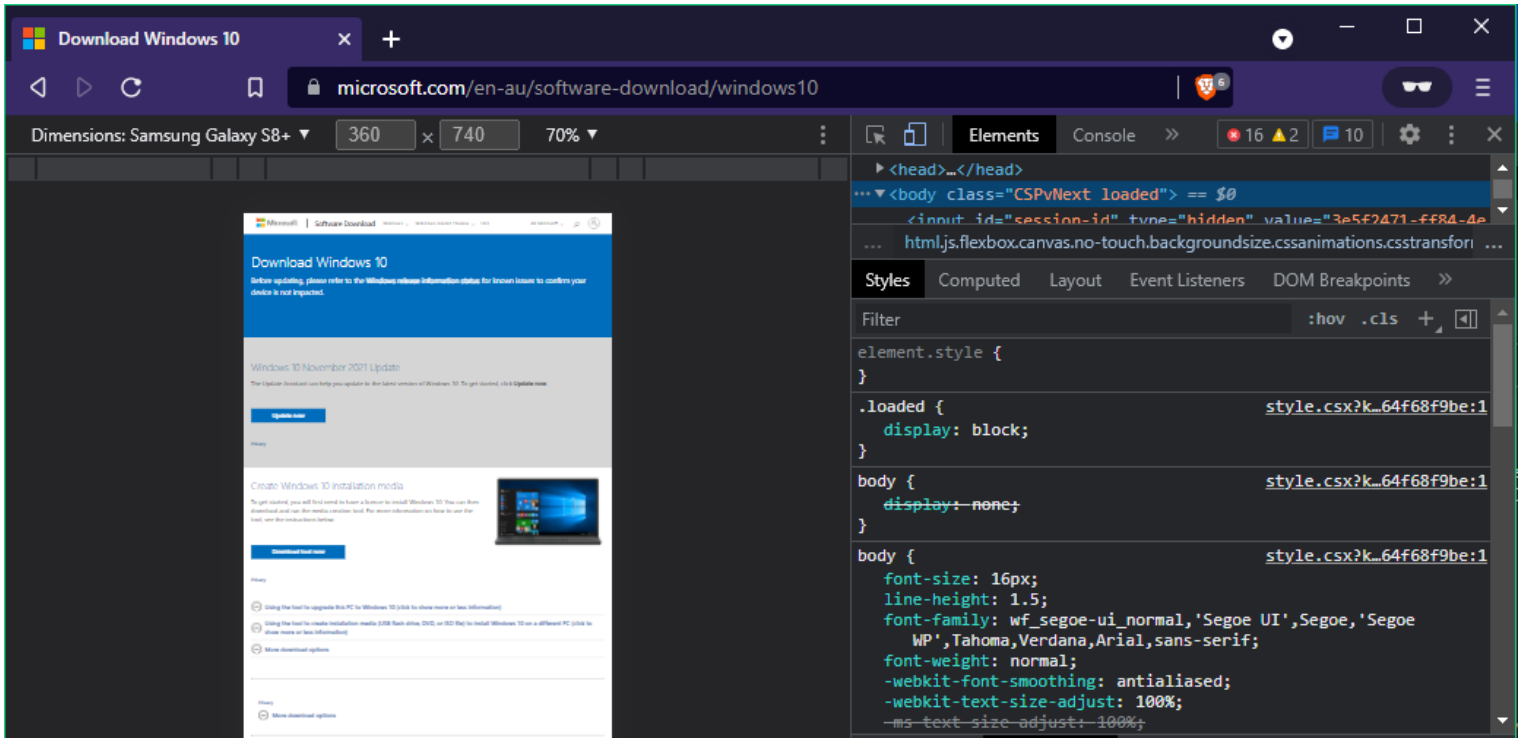
This screenshot shows the Developer tools option located in the More tools sub-menu within Chromium based web browsers.

Firefox



This screenshot shows the Web Developer Tools located within the More Tools sub-menu in Firefox browser.

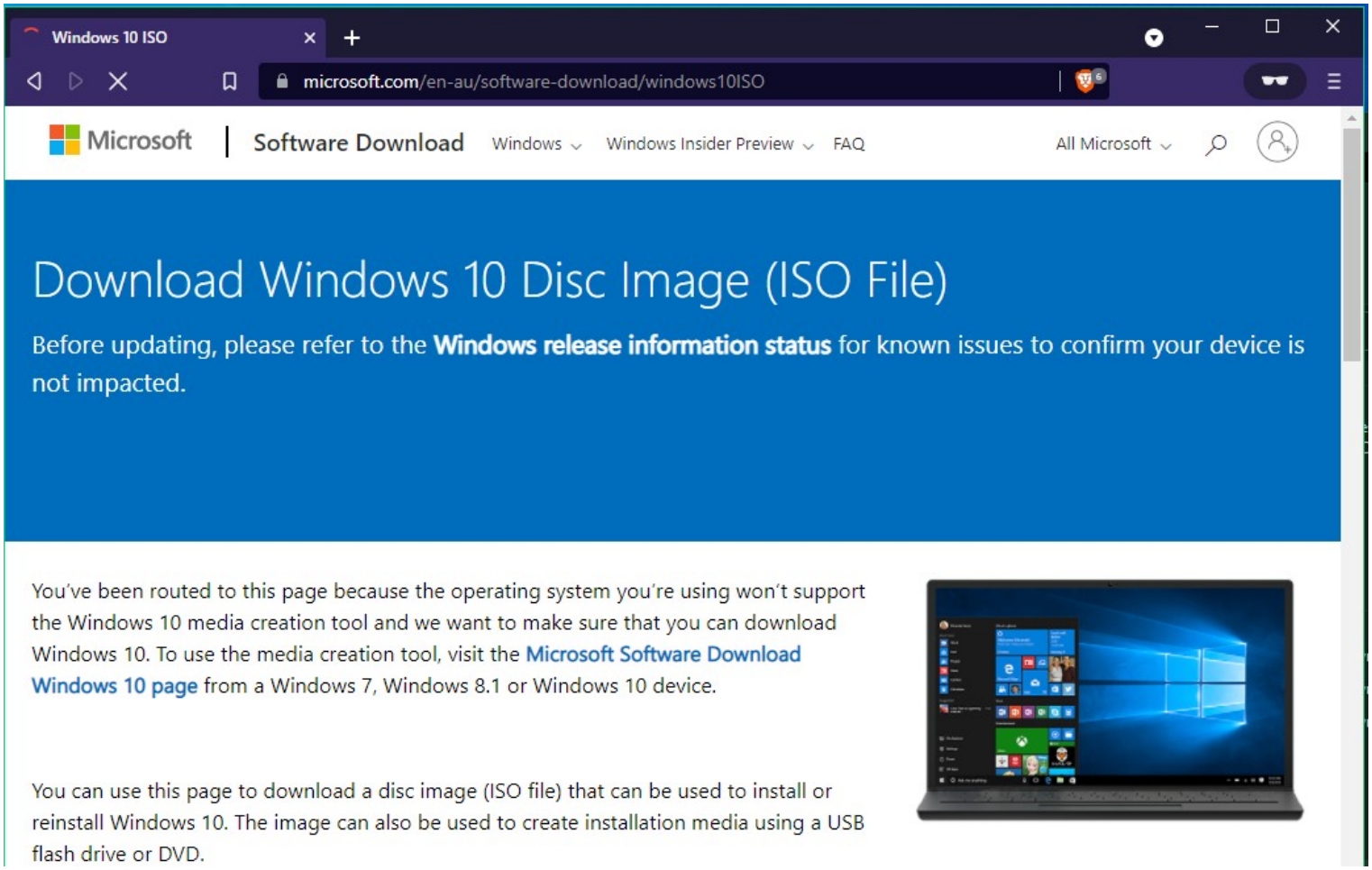
Within Developer Tools



You can see in this screenshot the device has been changed to a Samsung Galaxy S8+ (Android OS)

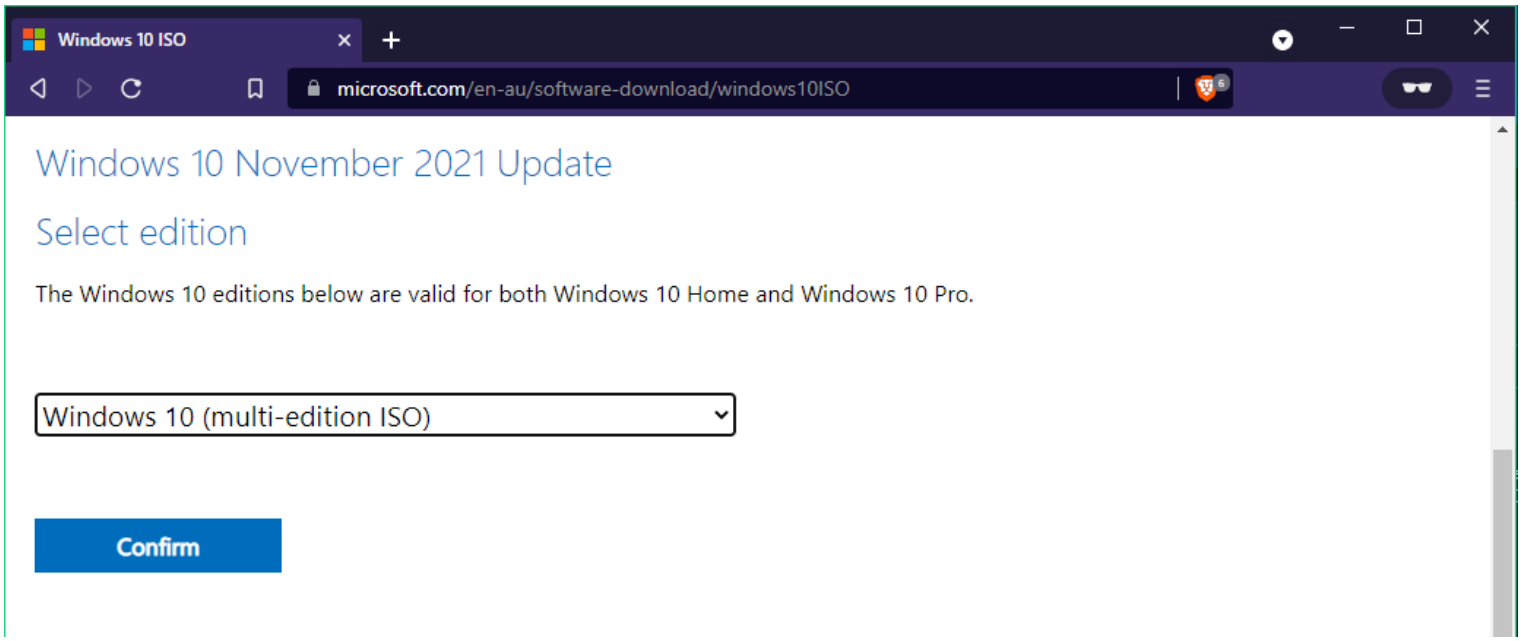
4. Refresh the page

By refreshing the page we update the changes we made within developer tools, you can now close developer tools pane.

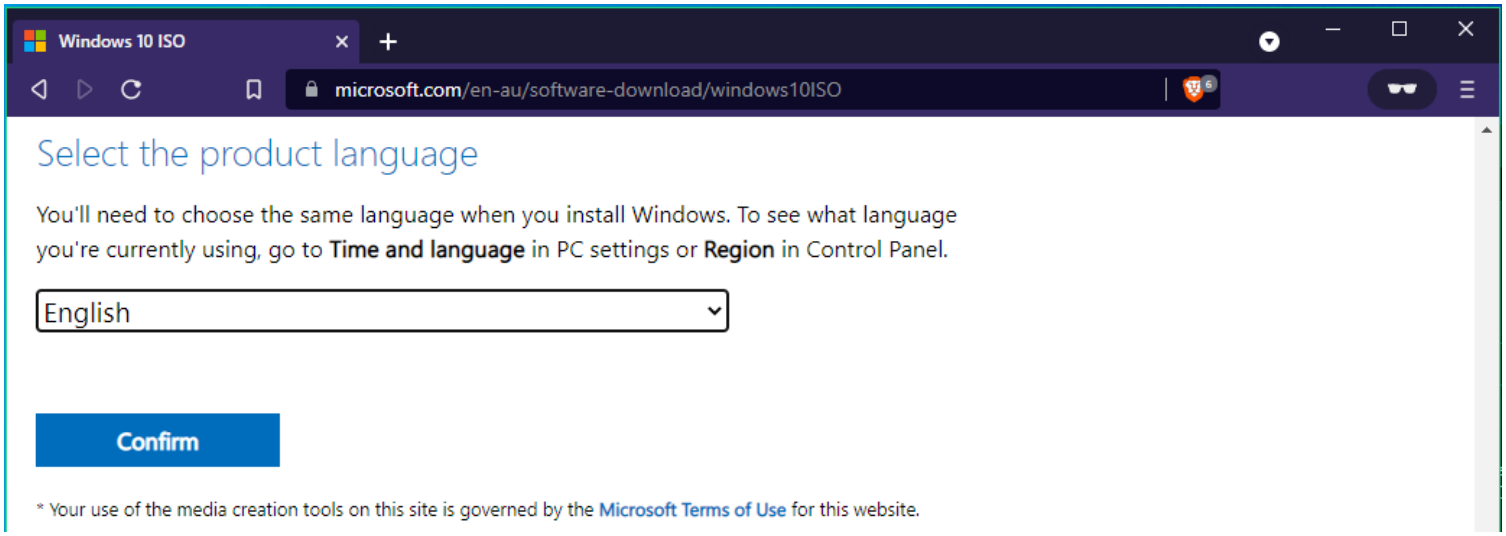


You can see we have now been routed to a different page offering a Windows 10 ISO file due to the manipulation we performed in the previous step.

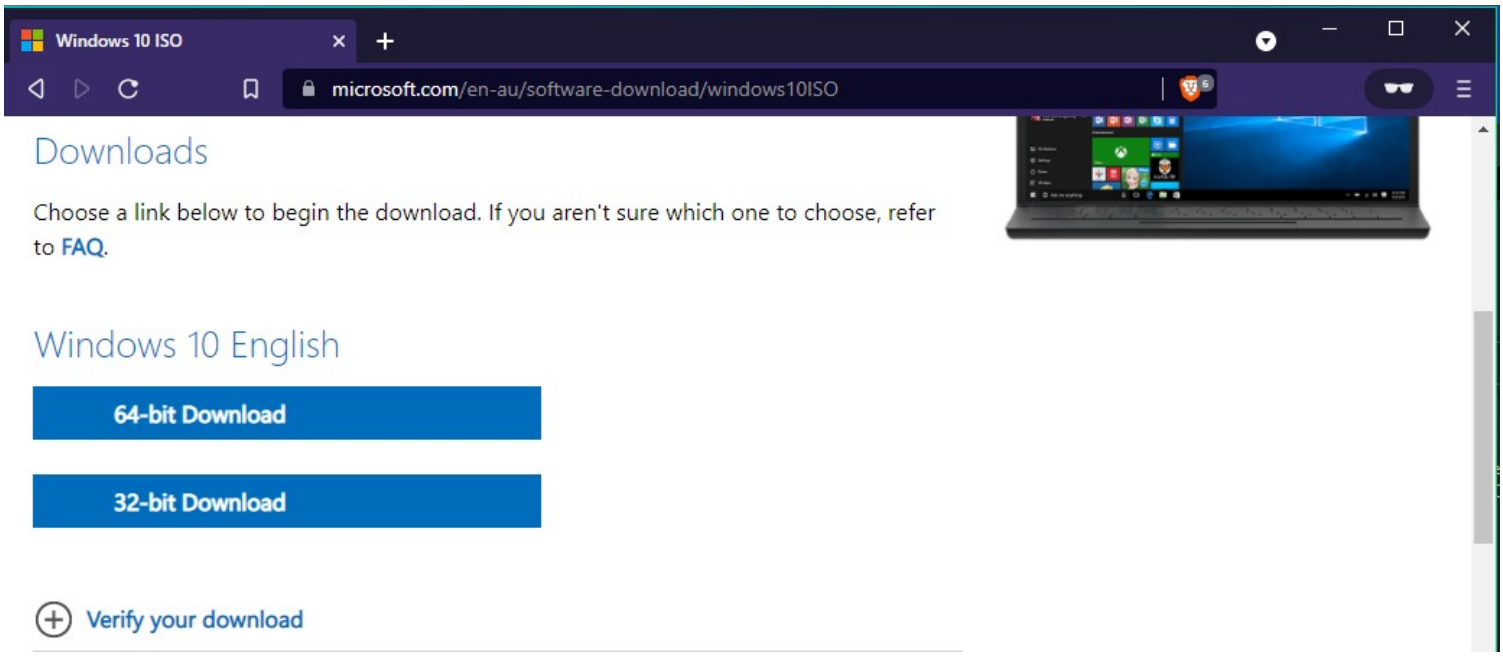
Scrolling down the page



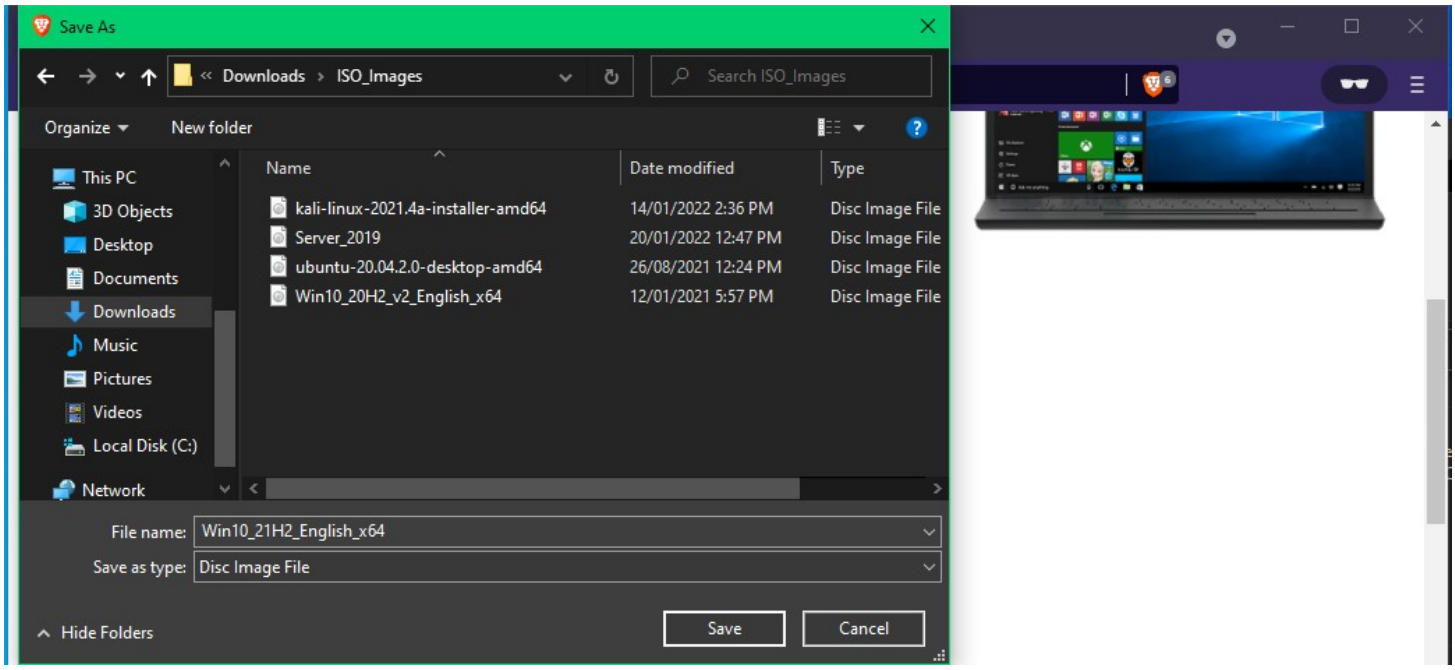
Confirm that we would like the multi-edition ISO – This includes Windows 10 Home and Professional versions. Note; In order to connect the Windows 10 VM to an Active Directory Domain we require either Professional or Enterprise version.



Select the language that you wish to download and confirm.



Select the architecture that you would like to download.

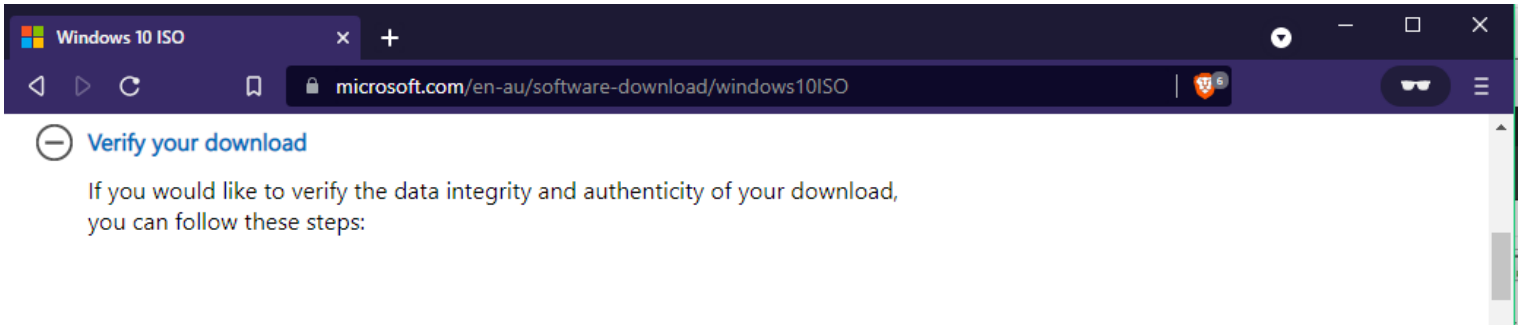


Navigate to the directory you wish to save the file and modify the filename if you desire.

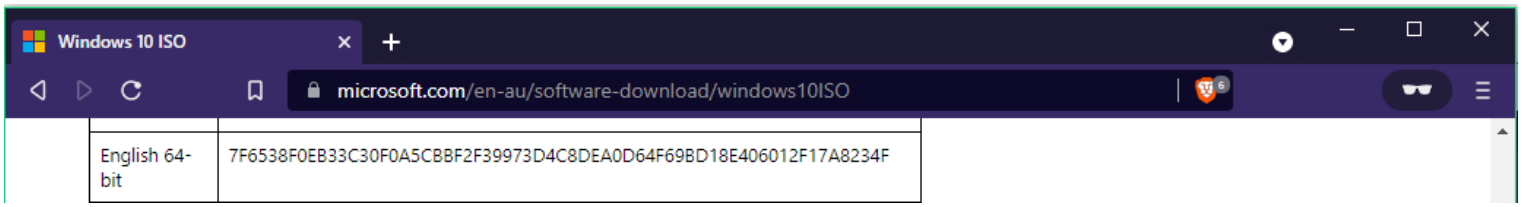
5. Verify the file hash – (Optional but Recommended)

A common way to verify the integrity of a file is by checking the hashed value of the downloaded file matches what is supplied by the vendor (usually listed near the download link).

It is recommended by to verify the downloaded files hash to ensure the file has not been tampered with, to do this Microsoft provide on the same page as the download commenced, the SHA256 hashes for the files they have available for download. The site also contains steps on how to verify the hash using Powershell which I will quickly walk through here.

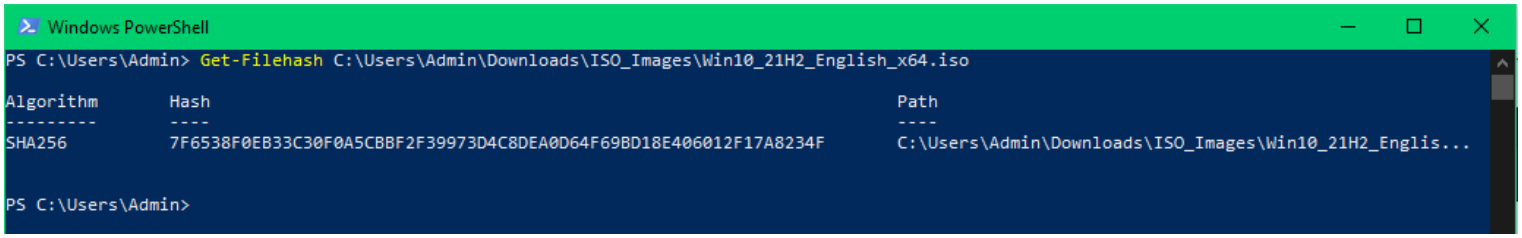


Under the Verify your download tab, it provides the steps that are used to verify the files hash is correct.



Scroll down the list until you have found the Exact version that you downloaded, in my case English 64-bit.

Now open Powershell and run the command; “Get-Filehash <path_to_file.iso>”



Looking at the files hash I can see that the hash values match from the Microsoft website and the downloaded .iso file. Meaning that the downloaded file has not been tampered with or corrupted and is an exact match with the original version supplied by Microsoft.

The command I used was “Get-Filehash C:\Users\Admin\Downloads\ISO_Images\Win10_21H2_English_x64.iso”

We can now proceed to create a Windows 10 virtual machine and connect it to a domain controller as a client.

Check my tutorials page for more!
https://m4773l.github.io/tutorials